

26
KALANITHI MARAN, 58
CHAIRMAN & FOUNDER, SUN GROUP

several European nations, Singapore, Malaysia, Sri Lanka, South Africa, Australia and New Zealand, Sun TV Network channels are available in 35 countries

BECAUSE the Sun Group also has 69 FM radio stations, three dailies, including the Tamil daily *Dinakaran*, with daily sales of over 1.4 million copies, and six magazines. Sun Direct, the Direct to Home Satellite TV service, has more than 16 million subscribers. Sun Pictures is the group's film producing division. It also owns the digital OTT platform, Sun NXT

GAME THEORY
The group owns the IPL team SunRisers Hyderabad and Sun-Risers Eastern Cape, a franchise in South Africa's SA20 T20 league. Maran's only child, Kaviya, 30, is co-owner and CEO of the teams

BECAUSE In 2022, Sun TV bought a Bombardier Global 7500, the world's largest and longest range business jet. Priced at $75 million, it has a range of 7,700 nautical miles, taking it as far as the US

SHAH OF CRICKET

27
JAY SHAH, 34
SECRETARY, BCCI & PRESIDENT, ACC

BECAUSE as secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India, he controls Indian cricket. The ODI World Cup, the game's biggest global show, will be held in India later this year under his supervision. Under him, IPL media rights multiplied threefold to Rs 48,390 crore, making it the second most valued sporting league in the world

NORTH BY NORTHEAST
Like the ruling BJP, he is focused on mainstreaming the Northeast. He has taken IPL matches to Guwahati; now, he is working on a plan to build a cricket stadium in each northeastern state. In 2021, Shah, at the age of just 32, became the youngest president of the Asian Cricket Council

BECAUSE he runs the richest cricket board in the world and his voice matters in the affairs of the International Cricket Council. The Shah-led ICC's Finance & Commercial Affairs Committee is all set to increase BCCI's share of ICC revenue to 37 per cent from the current 22.8 per cent. As ACC chief, he remained firm on his stand that India will not travel to Pakistan to play in the Asia Cup, which is scheduled later this year

BECAUSE he has played a key role in popularising women's cricket in India. The BCCI secretary decided to have pay parity for Indian women cricketers—now their match fees equal male cricketers'. BCCI launched the Women's Premier League this year under his watch



Illustration by **MANJUL**